



△ *Ivan III Tearing the Deed of the Tartar Khan*, Nikolai Shustov, 1862

1476

IVAN THE GREAT DEFIES THE KHAN

From the 13th century, Russian princes accepted the overlordship of Mongol-Turkic warriors. In 1476, Ivan III, Grand Duke of Moscow, refused to pay tribute to Khan Ahmed, head of the Tatar Golden Horde. Confirmed by defeat of the Tatars at the Ugra River in 1480, Ivan's assertion of independence allowed him to claim leadership of all Russian princes. Known as "the Great", he laid the foundations of the modern Russian state.

1476 **William Caxton**
sets up the first printing
press in England at
Westminster

1479

1474 **Renaissance artist**
Mantegna paints the
illusionistic bridal chamber
of the Ducal Palace, Mantua

1477 **At the Battle of
Nancy**, Swiss pikemen
defeat and kill Duke Charles
of Burgundy



▷ Spanish coin showing
Ferdinand and Isabella

1479 SPAIN UNITED

In 1469, Ferdinand and Isabella, heirs respectively to the Spanish kingdoms of Aragon and Castille, were married. Ten years later, having inherited their thrones, they became effectively joint rulers of a powerful united Spanish state. Known as the Catholic Monarchs, they used the Inquisition ruthlessly to root out non-believers, expelling all Jews in 1492. Defeating Muslim Granada, they extended their rule over the whole of Spain.

▷ Ferdinand V and Isabella I

